
Matei-Octavian Stănescu

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Education

National University of Science and Technology POLITEHNICA of Bucharest Bucharest, Romania

B.S. in Computer Science and Engineering. First Year Grade: 9.95/10

October 2024 - July 2028

Relevant Coursework: Data Structures and Algorithms, Algorithm Design and Analysis, Object-Oriented Programming, Operating Systems, Numerical Methods and Analysis

Honors & Awards

- **2025 and 2024: 4th place, Bronze Medal, Romanian Collegiate Programming Contest (RCPC), Bucharest**
- **2024: 3rd Prize, Gold Medal, National Informatics Olympiad, Bucharest**
- 2023: Honorable Mention, Silver Medal, National Informatics Olympiad, Bucharest
- 2023: National Team Qualification, Honorable Mention, Silver Medal, National Physics Olympiad, Oradea
- Additional medals: 1 silver and 1 bronze in Informatics (2022 and 2021), 2 silver in Physics, 1 silver and 2 bronze in Mathematics

Technical Experience, Leadership & Volunteering

Discover Citadel - Citadel & Citadel | Securities

London, UK, March 2026

- Selected as **1 of 95** attendees out of **9,400+** applicants
- Collaborated in teams to solve coding challenges and trading simulations
- Gained insights into the firm's technical infrastructure and culture through presentations by engineers from different teams, such as Low Latency Engineering

CEOI - Scientific Committee - SEPI Romania

Bucharest, December 2024 - July 2025

- Designed and proposed a problem for CEOI (**Central European Olympiad in Informatics**), developing stress tests defending against hacky solutions from participants.
- Engineered problems for 11th and 12th-grade participants in the **National Olympiad in Informatics** (ONI 2025 and 2026). Contributed to problem testing and evaluation.

CCNA Junior Instructor - Hackademy

Bucharest, October 2025 - January 2026

- **Taught the CCNA Introduction to Networks** course to a class of **35** college students at UPB.

Computer Science Olympiad Teacher - Spectrum School of Constanta

October 2022 - May 2023

- Trained ~ 20 middle school students for National Informatics Olympiad, covering algorithms and problem-solving techniques.

Projects

DraWar - Real-Time Multiplayer AI Drawing Game 

Bucharest, 2026

- Built a real-time multiplayer web game using Flask-SocketIO and eventlet, handling concurrent connections and game state synchronization with race condition mitigation.
- Trained a CNN on the Google QuickDraw dataset (45 classes) and deployed it as a separate FastAPI microservice to avoid blocking the WebSocket event loop.

Low Level HTTP Server in C

Bucharest, 2026

- Developed a low-level HTTP server in C over raw TCP sockets, using epoll-based I/O multiplexing and non-blocking sockets to handle thousands of concurrent connections.

Digit Recognition Neural Network in MATLAB

Bucharest, 2025

- Implemented forward propagation, backpropagation, and L2-regularized cost function from scratch in MATLAB, without high-level ML libraries.
- Trained a two-layer neural network (400-25-10) on an MNIST digit recognition task using Conjugate Gradient optimization.

Image Editor - C Project

Bucharest, 2024

- Developed a fully functional low-level command line image editor in C that features cropping, rotating, and algorithms for histogram calculation, equalization, blurring, sharpening and edge detection.

Skills & Interests

Technical: Intermediate in C, C++, Python, and Java.

Some experience with JavaScript, Kotlin, Dart, Flutter, Matlab, Bash, Flask, Assembly x86, HTML, Jinja.

Courses & Certifications: Google Android ABC Summer School, IPWorkshop Autonomous Cars Course, CCNA1, CCNA2, CCNA3, Security Summer School - Essentials Track

Competitive Programming and Hackathons: OpenHack Hackathon 2025, EESTEC Olympiad (Bitdefender CTF) 2025, RoNaQCI Quantum Hackathon 2025, NSDSS Network Design Hackathon 2025, AGM 2024, IIOT 2023-2024, Reply Challenge 2022-2023, CCC 2022-2023, UniHack 2022-2023, iTec 2022